FANGZHOU LIU (ANNE)

Financial Economist | AI, Causal Inference, and Product Innovation
Shanghai, China | +86 15000262175 | anne.fzliu@gmail.com |
https://liufangzhou-finance.github.io/

Professional Summary

Economist and empirical research scientist with a PhD in Finance and eight years of post-PhD research experience. Develops validated measurement strategies for ambiguous questions involving AI, information, product market competition, and firm behavior. Combines causal inference and quasi-experimental designs with large-scale structured and unstructured data, including LLM-assisted annotation, BERT text classification, product-level data, and standard firm-level financial data. Leads research from question formulation and data construction through modeling, publication, and communication to academic, policy, and interdisciplinary audiences. Published in the *Journal of Banking & Finance* and *Journal of Empirical Finance*.

Core Expertise

Causal inference: Difference-in-differences, stacked DiD, triple differences, event studies, instrumental-variable and quasi-experimental designs, matching, and high-dimensional fixed effects.
AI and measurement: LLM APIs, prompt-based annotation, BERT/NLP classification, model training and validation, human-labeled datasets, unstructured-text measurement, and scalable economic indicator construction.
Data and computing: Stata, Python, SAS, and SQL; large-scale data cleaning, entity matching, statistical analysis, and reproducible empirical workflows.
Data domains: Earnings-call transcripts, consumer product launches, patents, firm financials, analyst forecasts, executive compensation, stock trading, short selling, bank loans, and public economic indicators.

Professional Experience

Shanghai University of Finance and Economics — Assistant Professor of Finance **Oct 2018–Present**
Shanghai, China

- Lead research agendas on AI-enabled economic measurement, corporate innovation, information economics, and the effects of market and financial conditions on firm strategy.
- Translate open-ended economic questions into measurable outcomes, identification strategies, and end-to-end empirical projects; manage research design, data engineering, econometric modeling, validation, writing, and delivery.
- Build and analyze high-dimensional datasets linking company disclosures, unstructured text, product launches, patents, financial statements, capital markets, and executive characteristics.
- Mentor more than 20 master's students and teach empirical corporate finance, advanced corporate finance, financial statement analysis, and research writing across undergraduate, master's, and doctoral programs; ranked in the university's top 1% for teaching evaluations three times.
- Communicate technical methods and economic implications to interdisciplinary audiences at Peking University, NYU Shanghai, Indiana University, Georgetown University, CICF, AFA, FMA, and MFA.
- Organized the 2023 and 2024 SUFE Summer Workshops on Corporate Finance and Capital Markets and chaired a session at the inaugural China Corporate Finance Summer Forum.

Fudan University International School of Finance — Adjunct Instructor **2025–Present**
Shanghai, China

- Teach Financial Statement Analysis in an elite master's program, translating rigorous valuation and empirical concepts into decision-relevant narratives for mixed technical and business audiences.

Hong Kong Monetary Authority — Research Assistant **Oct 2011–Jun 2012**
Hong Kong

- Supported economists in monitoring macroeconomic and financial indicators and analyzing changes in housing prices, rents, and cross-market conditions in China and the United States.
- Constructed a contract-level dataset on entrusted lending by Chinese listed firms, extracting loan size, maturity, interest rates, and counterparties for research on non-bank credit.

Selected Research

Managerial Horizon: An LLM Approach
with Evgeny Lyandres and Chen Xu; CICF 2026

- Designed a new measure of managerial decision horizon from earnings-call text to distinguish attention to short-term operating performance from long-term strategy.
- Built a human-labeled corpus, used LLM-assisted annotation to expand training data, fine-tuned and validated a BERT classifier on 13,550 labeled passages, and classified more than 3 million passages at scale.
- Show that performance-focused managerial attention predicts lower subsequent R&D, capital expenditure, patenting, and long-run profitability, while strategy-focused attention predicts greater innovation and growth.

The Impact of Banking Deregulation on Competition and Product Innovation
Sole author; Journal of Empirical Finance, conditionally accepted

- Constructed barcode-level data spanning 32 consumer markets and 81 product categories and applied stacked DiD and triple-difference models to identify heterogeneous effects by competitive position.
- Find that deregulation increases breakthrough innovation among market leaders but reduces innovation among followers, revealing how financing and competition jointly shape product strategy.

Information Spillovers and Cross-Monitoring Between the Stock and Loan Markets
with Matt Billett and Xuan Tian; Journal of Banking & Finance, 2025; corresponding author

- Used the U.S. Regulation SHO pilot as an exogenous shock to short-selling constraints and integrated trading, short-interest, bank-loan, and ownership data to identify cross-market information effects.
- Show that bank monitoring changes information production and investor responses in equity markets, demonstrating substitution across information sources and monitoring mechanisms.

Analyst Coverage and Innovation: Evidence from New Product Introductions
Sole author; MFA Annual Meeting

- Combined barcode-level product launches with analyst, firm, and market data; used brokerage closures and mergers as plausibly exogenous variation in analyst coverage.
- Applied LLM-based analysis to earnings-call Q&A to measure analyst attention to radical innovation; show that this attention predicts subsequent breakthrough products and stronger announcement returns.

Financial Constraints and the Cyclicality of New Product Introductions
sole author; AFA AFFECT Mentoring Workshop 2025; sponsored by Shanghai Pujiang Talent Program

- Studies how macroeconomic fluctuations and financing constraints shape breakthrough versus incremental product innovation.

Ad-hoc Referee

Journal of Banking and Finance | Journal of Corporate Finance | Pacific-basin Finance Journal | China Finance Review International (CFRI)

Education

Indiana University, Kelley School of Business — PhD in Finance 2012–2018
The Chinese University of Hong Kong — BS in Quantitative Finance 2008–2012

Awards

Shanghai Pujiang Talent Program | Kelley School of Business Fellowship | AFA Travel Grant